only compliance artifacts but also an organization actively maintaining its commitment to protect customers and fulfill its obligations.

14.6 Best practices for policy governance

Policy governance works best when it includes clear ownership, consistent processes, and ongoing feedback. The principles guiding ACME's mature governance model apply at any level, whether managing a few policies or thousands across multiple systems.

14.6.1 Establish clear ownership and accountability

Every policy should have a designated owner responsible for its content and a clearly defined approver accountable for its release. These roles ensure that policies are not just anonymous documents but active commitments that someone maintains. Ownership should go beyond publication; owners remain responsible for tracking policy effectiveness and starting reviews when circumstances change.

14.6.2 Use shared templates and metadata

Consistency is essential for governance at scale. A standard template for policy documents—featuring sections for purpose, scope, ADR references, and metadata—simplifies review and auditing processes. Metadata tags, such as creation date, owner, review cycle, and related compliance domains, convert static text into searchable, traceable data.

14.6.3 Integrate governance into existing workflows

Governance should be integrated into the engineering process. Policies should undergo the same pipelines and approval workflows as code: version control, code review, testing, and deployment. Embedding governance in these steps keeps it efficient and guarantees that quality and compliance checks happen automatically instead of after the fact.